MODULE 3

Interview Prep

Prepare for your interview from format to follow up.

Name _____ **Date** _____

Six steps. Work through them before your interview. Bring the finished pages with you.

3.1 KNOW YOUR FORMAT

Step 1: Know your format

Check the format you have. Read the tips for it.

- ◯ **Phone Screen**
  15 to 30 minutes, first filter, no video
- ◯ **One-Way Video**
  You record. They review later.
- ◯ **In-Person Panel**
  Multiple interviewers at once
- ◯ **Live Video**
  Zoom, Teams, Google Meet
- ◯ **In-Person 1-on-1**
  One interviewer, direct conversation
- ◯ **In-Person Series**
  Back-to-back conversations

Phone Screen Tips

- Find a quiet room, background noise reads as unprepared.
- Have your resume in front of you. It's okay to reference it.
- Stand or sit up straight. Your posture changes your voice.
- Smile. It actually comes through in how you sound.
- It's okay to pause before answering. You don't need to fill every silence.

Live Video Tips

- Test camera, mic, and lighting the day before, not the day of.
- Look at the camera lens when you speak, not at your own face on screen.
- Use a plain, neutral background. Close other tabs. Silence notifications.
- Have a backup plan ready if your connection drops. Mention it upfront.
- Dress fully, top and bottom. It affects how you feel and carry yourself.

One-Way Video Tips

- Read the instructions twice before starting.
- Retakes are usually limited. Don't waste them on warmups.
- Look directly at the camera lens, not the screen.
- Dress and treat it exactly like a live interview.
- Record a test video first to check your framing, lighting, and audio.

In-Person 1-on-1 Tips

- Map the location the day before. Know the exact entrance.
- Arrive 10 to 15 minutes early. Not earlier.
- Greet the front desk warmly, they often share impressions.
- Bring three printed copies of your resume and a notepad.
- Make steady eye contact. You don't have to maintain it constantly, that's uncomfortable. Just natural and engaged.

In-Person Panel Tips

- Get the names of panel members in advance if you can. Use them.
- Address your answer to the person who asked, but briefly include the others.
- Don't be thrown by people taking notes. It's standard practice.
- Prepare for more questions and a longer conversation than a 1-on-1.
- It's okay to ask: "Who would I be working most closely with?", it helps you direct the conversation.

In-Person Series Tips

- You will repeat yourself. That's fine. Stay consistent across conversations.
- Each interviewer evaluates you independently. Treat each conversation as fresh.
- It's okay to ask the coordinator how many conversations to plan for.
- Bring enough resume copies for every person you might meet.
- Energy management matters. Take a breath between conversations when you can.

3.2 NIGHT BEFORE AND MORNING OF

Step 2: Show up ready

The night before (8 items)

- [ ] Shower and handle all hygiene basics
- [ ] Lay out full outfit. Check for stains, wrinkles and missing buttons
- [ ] Packed bag: resume copies (3 or more), notepad, pen, any requested documents
- [ ] Set two alarms for the morning
- [ ] Confirmed address, mapped route, know parking or transit
- [ ] Reviewed names of who you are meeting with
- [ ] Reviewed your three questions for the interviewer
- [ ] Tech check (if video): camera, mic, lighting, backup plan

The morning of (5 items)

- [ ] Eat something. Low blood sugar affects focus
- [ ] Brush teeth after coffee
- [ ] Check appearance in natural light
- [ ] Left earlier than needed. Arrive 10 to 15 minutes early
- [ ] Silence phone before entering the building

3.3 BEFORE YOU WALK IN

Step 3: Pre-interview email

Check the questions you need answered. Then write your email on the lines below. Short, professional and direct is the goal. You do not need to over-explain why you are asking.

- [ ] Who will I be meeting with? (names and titles)
- [ ] Confirm the interview format and platform
- [ ] How long should I plan for?
- [ ] Is there anything specific I should bring or prepare?
- [ ] Building entrance and parking or transit recommendation
- [ ] Will I receive questions or topic areas in advance?
- [ ] Request a quiet space or low-stimulation environment

To

Subject

Email draft

3.3 BUILD YOUR QUESTION LIST

Step 4: Questions for the interviewer

Pick at least three. Check the ones you will ask. Add your own at the end. Bring this page to the interview.

Role and success

- [ ] What does success look like in this role in the first 90 days?
- [ ] What is the biggest challenge someone new to this role typically faces?
- [ ] How has this role evolved over the past year?

Team and culture

- [ ] Can you describe the team I would be working with most closely?
- [ ] What do you enjoy most about working here?
- [ ] How does the team handle feedback and communication?

Process and next steps

- [ ] What are the next steps in your hiring process?
- [ ] What does onboarding typically look like for this role?
- [ ] Is there anything about my background you would like me to clarify?

My own questions

3.4 MOCK INTERVIEW PRACTICE

Step 5: Practice with STAR

Remember. STAR is a structure, not a script. Use it to keep your answers focused and complete. Practice enough that the structure becomes instinct.

“Tell me about yourself.”

S Situation
Who are you professionally? Where are you coming from?

T Task or focus
What are you focused on now? What are you looking for?

A Action or strengths
What do you bring? What is your strongest asset?

R Result or why this role
Connect your story to this specific opportunity.

☐ Practiced out loud

“Tell me about a time you handled a challenge.”

S Situation
What was the context? What was happening?

T Task
What was your specific responsibility in that situation?

A Action
What did you specifically do? Be concrete about your choices.

R Result
What happened? What did you learn?

☐ Practiced out loud

“Tell me about a time you worked with a difficult team member.”

S Situation
Brief context. What was the project or team dynamic?

T Task
What outcome was needed despite the friction?

A Action
What specific steps did you take to address it?

R Result
What happened? How did things resolve?

☐ Practiced out loud

“What is an area you are working to improve?”

S Situation or honest context
Name something real. Interviewers can tell when this is rehearsed.

T Task or why it matters
Why does improving this matter to you professionally?

A Action or what you are doing
What concrete steps are you taking to improve?

R Result or progress
What improvement have you seen, even if it is ongoing?

☐ Practiced out loud

Feedback checklist for mock interviews. After your practice run, ask: Did my answer address what was asked? Did I go too long? Was there a moment where I lost you? What one thing should I say differently?

INTERVIEW PREP SUMMARY

Step 6: Summary and quick reminders

☐ Format chosen and tips read
☐ Night before and morning of checklists done
☐ Pre-interview email written
☐ At least three questions chosen
☐ At least one STAR answer practiced out loud

Quick reminders

- Ask for accommodations before the interview if you need them. You do not have to disclose a diagnosis.
- Have your question list written down and bring it. Do not rely on memory.

- Arrive 10 to 15 minutes early. Greet the front desk warmly. They often share impressions.
- Practice out loud, not just in your head. Your brain will skip things your mouth stumbles over.